

CLAT GK - Test 01

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Budget 2026-27, repo rate holds and a strong Q1 GDP print

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman presented the Union Budget for 2026-27 in Parliament on 1 February 2026, a Sunday. It was her ninth consecutive Budget. She set the fiscal deficit target for 2026-27 at 4.3 per cent of GDP, or about Rs 16.95 lakh crore, slightly below the 4.4 per cent revised estimate for 2025-26, and said she had fulfilled her 2021-22 commitment to bring the deficit below 4.5 per cent of GDP by 2025-26. The Budget raised capital expenditure to about Rs 12.2 lakh crore and projected the Centre's debt at 55.6 per cent of GDP, with the stated aim of moving towards around 50 per cent by March 2031. Total expenditure was estimated at Rs 53.47 lakh crore.

Five days later, on 6 February 2026, the Reserve Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee, chaired by Governor Sanjay Malhotra, kept the policy repo rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent with a neutral stance, leaving the standing deposit facility rate at 5.00 per cent and the marginal standing facility rate and Bank Rate at 5.50 per cent. It was the Governor's first policy review after the Budget. The Committee repeated the decision on 5 June 2026, citing elevated crude oil prices amid the West Asia conflict and concerns about the monsoon. At its meeting of 3 to 5 August 2026, the MPC voted unanimously to hold the rate at 5.25 per cent once more and retained the neutral stance. The RBI projected real GDP growth of 6.7 per cent and consumer price inflation of 5.0 per cent for 2026-27. The repo rate had been lowered in several steps during 2025 before the pause began.

The central bank's growth projection was overtaken by official data on 31 August 2026. The National Statistical Office reported that India's real GDP grew 7.8 per cent in April-June 2026, the first quarter of 2026-27, against the RBI's own estimate of 7 per cent for the quarter. Nominal GDP rose 10.3 per cent to Rs 88.27 lakh crore. Gross value added grew 8.2 per cent, led by services, and gross fixed capital formation rose 11.9 per cent. The growth rate was lower than the upwardly revised 8.6 per cent recorded in the fourth quarter of 2025-26. ICRA raised its full-year forecast to 7.1 per cent from 6.7 per cent, though it flagged a poor monsoon and prolonged West Asia tensions as downside risks.

The MPC met again from 5 to 7 October 2026. Ahead of that meeting, most economists in polls expected the Committee to raise the repo rate by 25 basis points, which would be the first increase since February 2023.

Q1. The Union Budget presented in Parliament each year is constitutionally described as the 'annual financial statement'. Under which Article of the Constitution is it laid before Parliament?

- (A) Article 265
- (B) Article 114
- (C) Article 110
- (D) Article 112

Q2. The National Statistical Office, which released the Q1 2026-27 GDP estimate, functions under which Union Ministry?

- (A) Ministry of Finance
- (B) Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- (C) Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
- (D) NITI Aayog

Q3. Assertion (A): Salaries of Supreme Court judges are not subject to a vote by the Lok Sabha when the Budget is passed.

Reason (R): Such expenditure is charged on the Consolidated Fund of India.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q4. Statement I. The Monetary Policy Committee has six members, three of whom are from the Reserve Bank of India including the Governor as ex-officio chairperson.

Statement II. The inflation target for the MPC is set by the Central Government in consultation with the Reserve Bank, at 4 per cent with an upper tolerance level of 6 per cent and a lower level of 2 per cent.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q5. Statement I. The Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management Act was enacted in 2003.

Statement II. The Act, as amended in 2018, set a target of limiting the Centre's fiscal deficit to 3 per cent of GDP.

Statement III. The 2018 amendment allows deviation from the fiscal deficit target by up to 1 percentage point of GDP under an escape clause.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) All of the above

FIFA World Cup 2026: Spain crowned champions

The 2026 FIFA World Cup, the first to be hosted jointly by three nations, ran for 39 days from 11 June to 19 July 2026. It was also the first edition expanded to 48 teams, split into 12 groups of four, a structure that guaranteed every team at least three matches, and featured a record 104 matches across 16 host cities, of which 11 were in the United States, three in Mexico and two in Canada. The opening game on 11 June was played at the Estadio Azteca in Mexico City, where Mexico beat South Africa 2-0 through goals from Julian Quinones and Raul Jimenez. South Africa finished the match with nine men, and the game produced three red cards in all.

The tournament ended on 19 July at MetLife Stadium in New Jersey, where Spain defeated defending champion Argentina 1-0 after extra time before a crowd of 80,663. Ferran Torres, who had come on as a substitute, scored the only goal early in the second period of extra time, in the 106th minute. Argentina had been reduced to ten men late in normal time when Enzo Fernandez received a second yellow card, and goalkeeper Emiliano Martinez made 11 saves, a record for a World Cup final, without being able to deny Spain. The victory gave Spain its second world title.

Spain also dominated the individual honours announced after the final. Midfielder Rodri was named winner of the Golden Ball as the best player of the tournament, while goalkeeper Unai Simon took the Golden Glove after Spain conceded just one goal in the whole tournament. Argentina's captain took the Silver Ball and Mbappe, of France, the Bronze Ball. Pau Cubarsi beat his Spain teammate Lamine Yamal to the best young player award, and the Fair Play award went to the Netherlands. The Golden

Boot, however, went to France's Kylian Mbappe, who scored 10 goals, the most at a single World Cup since 1970, and finished two clear of the runner-up, who ended on eight goals. England's Jude Bellingham took third place in the scoring list with seven goals.

For Mbappe, the award extended a remarkable run at the sport's biggest event: he became the first player to win the Golden Boot twice, and his tally lifted him to 22 career World Cup goals, a men's all-time record. For Spain, the result capped a tournament in which its defence was breached only once. The tournament's expanded format meant that the eventual champion had to navigate a new round of 32, introduced because the top two sides from every group and the eight best third-placed teams advanced.

Q6. Spain's win over Argentina in the 2026 final was its second World Cup title. In which year did Spain win its first, beating the Netherlands 1-0 after extra time?

- (A) 2014
- (B) 2010
- (C) 2006
- (D) 2008

Q7. Argentina entered the 2026 final as defending champion. Which player won the Golden Ball at the 2022 World Cup, and remains the only player to have won that award twice?

- (A) Antoine Griezmann
- (B) Luka Modric
- (C) Kylian Mbappe
- (D) Lionel Messi

Q8. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. 2010 World Cup final	A. Soccer City, Johannesburg
II. 2022 World Cup final	B. Lusail Stadium, Lusail
III. 2026 World Cup final	C. MetLife Stadium, New Jersey
IV. 2026 World Cup opening match	D. Estadio Azteca, Mexico City

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C

Q9. Statement I. Kylian Mbappe won the Golden Boot at the 2022 World Cup with eight goals.

Statement II. Argentina beat France in the 2022 final in regulation time, 2-1, without the need for extra time.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q10. Statement 1. The FIFA World Cup trophy was designed by the Italian sculptor Silvio Gazzaniga.

Statement 2. The trophy is made of 18-carat gold.

Statement 3. The trophy weighs about 6.175 kg.

Statement 4. The trophy is solid gold throughout, with no hollow interior.

How many of the above statements are incorrect?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Article 21 Widened: Menstrual Health and Passive Euthanasia

Two rulings delivered by the Supreme Court in the first quarter of 2026 have widened the reach of the right to life in different directions, and Justice J.B. Pardiwala sat on the bench in both.

On 30 January 2026, a bench of Justices Pardiwala and R. Mahadevan decided *Dr. Jaya Thakur v. Government of India*. The petition, filed in 2022 by social activist Jaya Thakur, had sought free sanitary pads for girls in classes 6 to 12 and separate toilets for girls in schools. The Court held that menstrual health is part of the right to life under Article 21, and that poor menstrual hygiene management is not merely a sanitation problem but a violation of the fundamental rights to equality, dignity and education. It said the absence of gender-segregated toilets and menstrual hygiene facilities is a constitutional barrier to schooling for adolescent girls, engaging Articles 14, 21 and 21A. The bench directed the Union, the states and the Union Territories to ensure that schools, whether government-run, aided or private, provide free sanitary napkins, maintain functional, gender-segregated toilets and arrange for the safe disposal of menstrual waste. Private schools that fail to comply risk derecognition.

On 11 March 2026, a different bench of Justices Pardiwala and K.V. Viswanathan decided *Harish Rana v. Union of India*. Rana, reported to be about 31 or 32 years old, had been in a persistent vegetative state for over thirteen years after a fall from the fourth floor of his accommodation in 2013 left him with a severe brain injury. His parents had first approached the Delhi High Court, which declined relief on the ground that he was not on mechanical life support and was not terminally ill. They then came to the Supreme Court, which initially gave them liberty to return if further directions were needed. Two medical boards constituted by the Court later concluded that he had no chance of recovery, and the bench reserved its judgment on 15 January 2026.

The Court allowed withdrawal of life-sustaining treatment, including clinically assisted nutrition and hydration, which it treated as medical treatment rather than basic nursing care. It applied the "best interest" principle and the guidelines flowing from *Common Cause v. Union of India*, as modified in 2023. It waived the usual 30-day reconsideration period because all stakeholders agreed, and directed AIIMS, New Delhi, to admit him to its palliative care department. It also asked the Union government to consider comprehensive legislation on passive euthanasia. He was shifted on 14 March to the palliative care unit at the Dr B.R. Ambedkar Institute Rotary Cancer Hospital, AIIMS, where a team led by Dr Seema Mishra supervised the gradual withdrawal of treatment. Rana died on 24 March 2026. Reports describe it as the first such case of passive euthanasia allowed by a court in India.

Taken together, the judgments show the Court continuing to read Article 21 as more than mere animal existence, covering health, bodily autonomy and dignity from the school toilet to the hospital bed.

Q11. The Jaya Thakur ruling stressed that menstrual hygiene facilities are linked to the education of girls. Which Article of the Constitution expressly permits the State to make special provisions for women and children despite the bar on discrimination?

- (A) Article 16(4)
- (B) Article 14
- (C) Article 19(1)(g)
- (D) Article 15(3)

Q12. Which seven-judge Supreme Court decision, with a leading opinion by Justice Bhagwati, read the words 'procedure established by law' in Article 21 as requiring a procedure that is fair, just and reasonable, and so underpins the wide modern reading of the right to life?

- (A) A.K. Gopalan v. State of Madras
- (B) Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India
- (C) Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala
- (D) Minerva Mills v. Union of India

Q13. Assertion (A): Before Article 21A existed, the Supreme Court in Unni Krishnan, J.P. v. State of Andhra Pradesh had read a right to free education for children up to a certain age into Article 21.

Reason (R): Article 21A was later inserted into the Constitution by the Eighty-sixth Amendment Act, 2002, and the RTE Act 2009 is the law implementing it.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q14. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India	A. 1978
II. Unni Krishnan v. State of Andhra Pradesh	B. 1993
III. Common Cause v. Union of India (Constitution Bench)	C. 2011
IV. Aruna Shanbaug v. Union of India	D. 2018

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C

Q15. Statement 1. The Common Cause judgment on the right to die with dignity was delivered by a five-judge Constitution Bench.

Statement 2. A.K. Gopalan v. State of Madras treated the fundamental rights as separate, watertight compartments, an approach the Supreme Court later departed from.

Statement 3. In Unni Krishnan, the Supreme Court held that the right to education up to a professional degree flows directly from Article 21.

Statement 4. In Aruna Shanbaug v. Union of India, the Supreme Court allowed passive euthanasia in certain circumstances under court monitoring.

How many of the above statements are incorrect?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

India's BRICS Chairship 2026

India formally took over the BRICS chairship from Brazil on 1 January 2026, becoming chair of the grouping for the fourth time. Twelve days later, on 13 January, External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar unveiled the logo, website and theme of the presidency in New Delhi. The theme, "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability", was tied by officials to the people-centric approach Prime Minister Narendra Modi had outlined at the previous year's summit in Rio de Janeiro. The chairship runs for the calendar year, from 1 January to 31 December, and the chair sets the agenda for meetings at every level, from sherpas and ministers to the leaders' summit.

The calendar of ministerial meetings began to fill in the middle of the year. Foreign ministers and heads of delegation from member and partner countries gathered at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on 14 and 15 May 2026. Jaishankar chaired the meeting, which was overshadowed by the crisis in West Asia, and the delegates later called on Modi. On 22 and 23 June, National Security Adviser Ajit Doval hosted the 16th meeting of BRICS national security advisers in the capital. Russia's Security Council Secretary Sergey Shoigu and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi were among those who attended. The agenda was built around non-traditional security challenges, and Doval used the sidelines to hold bilateral talks with officials from Iran, Brazil, Ethiopia and South Africa.

The presidency culminated in the 18th BRICS Summit, held at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, on 12 and 13 September 2026. On the first day, Modi announced that leaders had adopted the New Delhi Declaration by consensus, with no member raising an objection. Reports said hard negotiations, which ran until the early hours, were needed to bridge sharp differences between Iran and the United Arab Emirates over the West Asia conflict, with India acting as mediator. The 140-paragraph document ranges across global governance reform, peace and security, trade and finance, technology, climate and people-to-people cooperation. It backed a larger role for India and Brazil at the United Nations, criticised unilateral tariffs and secondary sanctions, and condemned the 22 April 2025 terror attack in Jammu and Kashmir. It also called for a ceasefire in Gaza and endorsed India-led initiatives on financial risk, artificial intelligence and big-cat conservation.

The declaration also welcomed what it called significant progress under India's presidency and pledged support for China, which will take over the rotating chair in 2027. India's turn came at a time when the bloc, which has expanded considerably through enlargement in recent years, is trying to balance members with very different positions on the conflicts in West Asia. Reports described the ability to produce a consensus text, even after hard bargaining, as a major diplomatic win for India at the Delhi summit.

Q16. The BRICS grouping's own multilateral lender, the New Development Bank, has its headquarters in which city?

- (A) Johannesburg
- (B) Moscow
- (C) New Delhi
- (D) Shanghai

Q17. Which BRICS member held the rotating chair in 2024, the year before Brazil?

- (A) India
- (B) Russia
- (C) China
- (D) South Africa

Q18. Assertion (A): Indonesia is a full member of BRICS.

Reason (R): Brazil held the rotating BRICS chair in 2025.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
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Q19. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. 2011 BRICS summit	A. Durban
II. 2012 BRICS summit	B. Fortaleza
III. 2013 BRICS summit	C. New Delhi
IV. 2014 BRICS summit	D. Sanya

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q20. Statement I. India's most recent chairship of BRICS before 2026 was in 2021.

Statement II. South Africa's admission in 2010 led the BRIC grouping to be renamed BRICS.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q21. Statement 1. The acronym BRIC was coined in 2001 by Goldman Sachs economist Jim O'Neill.

Statement 2. The first formal BRIC leaders' summit was held in Yekaterinburg, Russia, in June 2009.

Statement 3. South Africa's first summit as a full member of the grouping was held in 2011.

Statement 4. The Agreement on the New Development Bank was signed in 2013.

How many of the above statements are incorrect?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

PSLV-C62 failure and the road to Gaganyaan

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman presented the Union Budget for 2026-27 in Parliament on 1 February 2026, a Sunday. It was her ninth consecutive Budget. She set the fiscal deficit target for 2026-27 at 4.3 per cent of GDP, slightly below the 4.4 per cent revised estimate for 2025-26, and said she had fulfilled her 2021-22 commitment to bring the deficit below 4.5 per cent of GDP by 2025-26. The Budget raised capital expenditure to about Rs 12.2 lakh crore and projected the Centre's debt at 55.6 per cent of GDP, with the stated aim of moving towards around 50 per cent by March 2031. Total expenditure was estimated at Rs 53.47 lakh crore.

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The central bank's growth projection was overtaken by official data on 31 August 2026. The National Statistical Office reported that India's real GDP grew 7.8 per cent in April-June 2026, the first quarter of 2026-27, against the RBI's own estimate of 7 per cent for the quarter. Nominal GDP rose 10.3 per cent to Rs 88.27 lakh crore. Gross value added grew 8.2 per cent, led by services, and gross fixed capital formation rose 11.9 per cent. The growth rate was lower than the upwardly revised 8.6 per cent recorded in the fourth quarter of 2025-26. ICRA raised its full-year forecast to 7.1 per cent from 6.7 per cent, though it flagged a poor monsoon and prolonged West Asia tensions as downside risks.

The MPC met again from 5 to 7 October 2026. Ahead of that meeting, most economists in polls expected the Committee to raise the repo rate by 25 basis points, which would be the first increase since February 2023.

Q22. The Sriharikota spaceport, from which PSLV-C62 was launched, is officially named after which scientist and former ISRO chairman?

- (A) A. P. J. Abdul Kalam
- (B) Satish Dhawan
- (C) Vikram Sarabhai
- (D) Homi J. Bhabha

Q23. Assertion (A): India's planned second spaceport at Kulasekarapattinam is intended mainly for launching small satellites on the SSLV.

Reason (R): A launch site on the southern tip of the peninsula lets rockets fly directly south to polar orbits, avoiding the curved trajectory that Sriharikota launches need to stay clear of Sri Lanka.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q24. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. ISRO headquarters	A. Thiruvananthapuram
II. Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (lead centre for launch vehicles)	B. Bengaluru
III. Satish Dhawan Space Centre (Sriharikota)	C. Tirupati district, Andhra Pradesh
IV. Kulasekarapattinam spaceport (under construction)	D. Thoothukudi district, Tamil Nadu

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q25. Statement I. The PSLV is a four-stage vehicle whose third stage (PS3) uses solid propellant.

Statement II. The very first PSLV flight, PSLV-D1 on 20 September 1993, successfully placed its satellite in orbit.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q26. Statement I. ISRO was formed on 15 August 1969, succeeding the Indian National Committee for Space Research (INCOSPAR) set up in 1962.

Statement II. ISRO's headquarters is located in Thiruvananthapuram.

Statement III. ISRO functions under the Department of Space.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) All of the above

Q27. The uncrewed Gaganyaan test flight G1 is planned on a human-rated version of which ISRO launch vehicle?

- (A) PSLV
- (B) GSLV Mk II
- (C) SSLV
- (D) LVM3